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AFJ | Auto Fin Journal
Business Intelligence for Automotive and Auto Fintech Executives

WEDNESDAY, OCT. 21, 2026

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FLOORPLAN

Shull chosen to lead First Business Bank's floorplan operation

The unit writes floorplan programs from about $1 million to more than $20 million

Drew Shull has taken over as president of floorplan financing at First Business Specialty Finance, a First Business Bank subsidiary. He will lead the unit, which offers floorplan programs running from about $1 million to more than $20 million for larger, established independent dealers.

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No code. No car.

ACERTified verifies driver identity at the pickup stage of vehicle transport. Your designated release agent and the assigned driver confirm a text code two ways; if it matches, the system greenlights release and both sides get a digital confirmation. A first-of-its-kind safeguard against pickup-stage fraud, from the largest automotive logistics platform in North America.

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PEOPLE

DigniFi names chief product officer

Jefim Piekarz has been appointed to lead the product and engineering teams at the repair-financing fintech.

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Dealers attend Used Car Week free
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LENDERS

Latest two moves by US Bank have dealers & OEMs in mind

U.S. Bank announced two automotive-focused initiatives, among them redesigned BMW, MINI and BMW Motorrad credit cards.

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One dealership. One month of outbound.

2,000+ customers reached, 500+ appointments booked and $250K+ in attributed revenue — fully automated, from first call to booked appointment. mia is a 24/7 automotive AI phone agent covering reception, sales, service and outbound, replacing fragmented tech with one platform built to deliver ROI from the first conversation.

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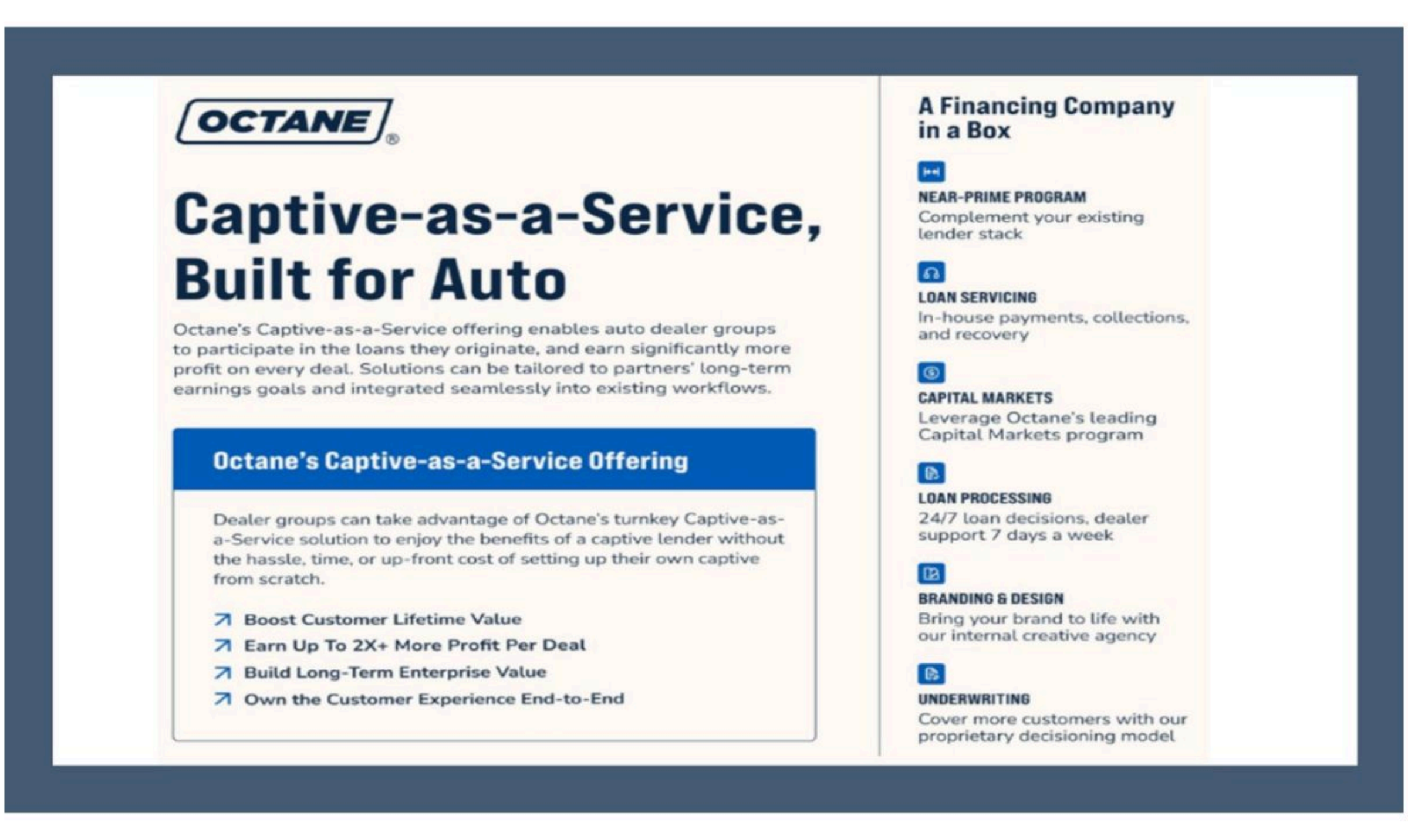
LENDERS

Octane hires VP of sales and partnerships to sustain captive-as-a-service momentum



OCTANE

Captive-as-a-Service, Built for Auto

Octane's Captive-as-a-Service offering enables auto dealer groups to participate in the loans they originate, and earn significantly more profit on every deal. Solutions can be tailored to partners' long-term earnings goals and integrated seamlessly into existing workflows.

Octane's Captive-as-a-Service Offering

Dealer groups can take advantage of Octane's turnkey Captive-as-a-Service solution to enjoy the benefits of a captive lender without the hassle, time, or up-front cost of setting up their own captive from scratch.

- Boost Customer Lifetime Value
- Earn Up To 2X+ More Profit Per Deal
- Build Long-Term Enterprise Value
- Own the Customer Experience End-to-End

A Financing Company in a Box

NEAR-PRIME PROGRAM
Complement your existing lender stack

LOAN SERVICING
In-house payments, collections, and recovery

CAPITAL MARKETS
Leverage Octane's leading Capital Markets program

LOAN PROCESSING
24/7 loan decisions, dealer support 7 days a week

BRANDING & DESIGN
Bring your brand to life with our internal creative agency

UNDERWRITING
Cover more customers with our proprietary decisioning model

The hire supports Octane's captive-as-a-service program, which brings together servicing, underwriting, technology and capital markets.

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EDITOR'S PICKS

COMMENTARY

COMMENTARY: The LLM compliance paradox & separating conversational AI from quantitative underwriting

Where large language models belong in a lending stack, and where they do not.

COMMENTARY

COMMENTARY: Calibrating AI risk models for shifting macroeconomic cycles

Keeping a risk model honest when the macro picture moves under it.

TECHNOLOGY

RouteOne and Alfa expand integration for eContracting & leases

Alfa earned certification for RouteOne's eContracting and lease integrations.

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Win with your cards face-up

Show car buyers you have nothing up your sleeve. $540 billion in automotive commerce runs through CDK dealership software and systems every year — unrivaled scale, deep industry expertise and a record of innovation that helps dealers fuel growth, increase efficiency and achieve stronger business results.

WIN WITH CDK ›

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New episodes of the Auto Remarketing Podcast.

OCT. 21
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Ben Sporn of VIP Automotive Group Takes DIY Approach to AI

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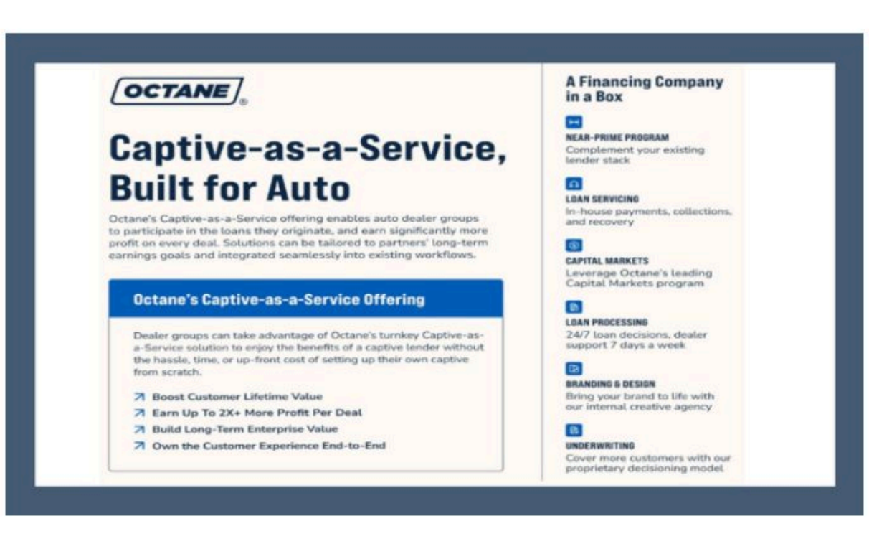
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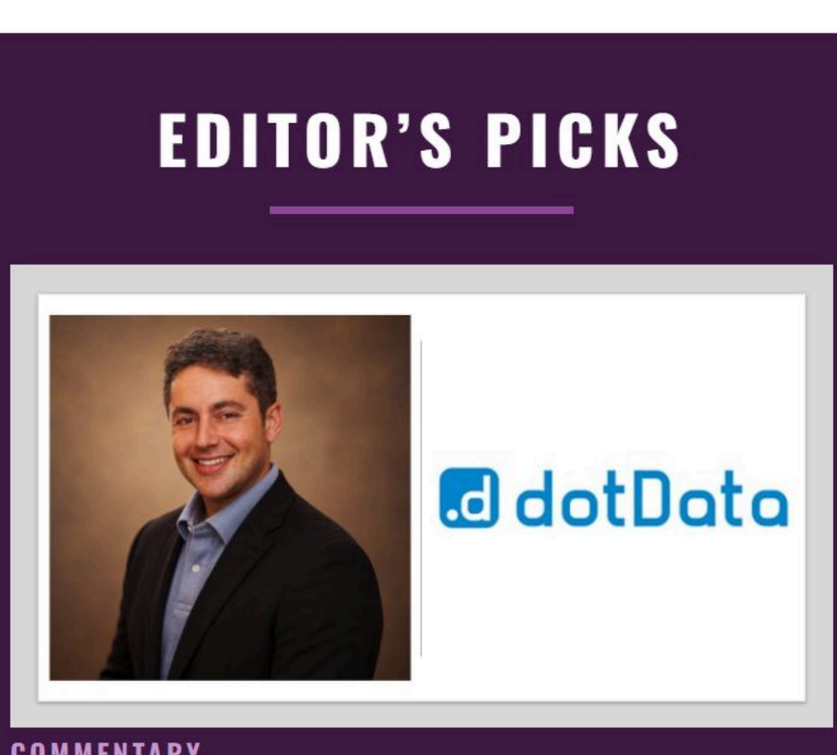

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